COLORADO
Information Security
Governor's Office of Information Technology

TS-CISO-005: Patch Management Standard

Document ID	TS-CISO-005
Title	Patch Management Standard
Executive Sponsor	Jill Fraser, Chief Information Security Officer
Issuing Authority	Governor's Office of Information Technology (OIT)
Applies to	All state government employees, contractors, vendors, and external users who access state government information systems and applications, regardless of location or device, including all applications, hosting environments, and physical and connected technologies.
Instrument Type	Standard
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Purpose

This standard defines security requirements for the timely application of patches and updates across all State-managed information systems and applications, including on-premises and cloud environments. It supports compliance with the Colorado Information Security Policies (CISPs).

Scope

This standard applies to all state government employees, contractors, vendors, and external users who access state government information systems and applications, regardless of location or device. This includes all applications and hosting environments, and access to physical and connected technologies.

Requirements

The appropriate patch management standard requirements are listed below. Additional requirements must be implemented based on the regulated data type(s).

Vulnerability Scanning

Requirement	Detail
Frequency	Vulnerability scans shall be conducted regularly, at least weekly.
Tools	Scans shall be conducted using an industry-approved vulnerability scanner.

Requirement	Detail
Results	Scan results must be made available to the appropriate staff.

Patching Timeframes

Severity Level	System Type	Timeframe	Configuration Requirement
Critical, High, and Medium	Servers	Patches applied within 30 days of patch release.	All configurations required to make a patch “active” must be fully applied in the same timeframe.
Critical, High, and Medium	Workstations	Patches pushed to them within 30 days.	—
Low-Severity & Secure Configuration	All systems	May be applied on a scheduled basis or as resources permit, as determined by team SOPs.	—

Exceptions

All exceptions must be documented, justified, and approved by the State of Colorado's Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) or other designated authority. Compensating controls must be documented, implemented, and maintained.

Compliance

The Information Security Office will monitor and advise on compliance with this standard.